

Parent Statement for Partner Services

1. Welcome to our Partner Service

Ash's Angels Preschool, Lower Quarters Mallow P51V3FY, is a Partner Service, working together with the Department of Children, Disability and Equality, and parents/guardians to deliver high quality, affordable, inclusive Early Learning and Care (ELC) and/or School Age Childcare (SAC) services for children under Together for Better.

Together for Better is the funding model for early learning and childcare that brings together four major programmes, the Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE) programme - including the Access and Inclusion Model (AIM), the National Childcare Scheme (NCS), Core Funding, and Equal Start.

As a Partner Service, we offer subsidy schemes to parents/guardians and receive Core Funding in return for adhering to the scheme's terms and conditions outlined in the Core Funding Partner Service Agreement. Further information on Core Funding is available here: <https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/campaigns/core-funding/>.

Core Funding, which began in September 2022, is a supply side funding stream to develop a closer partnership for the public good between the State and providers. Its primary purpose is to improve affordability and accessibility for parents, pay and conditions in the sector, and income stability for providers.

This Parent Statement outlines some of the important things you can expect from us, as a Partner Service. This Parent Statement is provided as a condition of the Core Funding Partner Service Funding Agreement, the NCS, ECCE and CCSP Saver Funding agreements.

This Parent Statement describes the agreement in place between us Ash's Angels Preschool and the parents/guardians that use our service with respect to fees charged to parents/guardians, and as a Partner Service we have committed to adhere to Core Funding's terms and conditions regarding fee management.

1.1 About Us

Here are some of the basic things to know about us:

A typical week for us is 08:30 to 15:00 Monday to Friday for 38 weeks per year.

At Ash's Angels Preschool we offer the following services to children and their families:

☐	Sessional Care for Early Learning & Care (ELC) excluding ECCE provision
☒	Sessional preschool under ECCE (Free Preschool)
☐	Full day care/part time care for Early Learning & Care (ELC)
☐	Term time School Age Childcare
☐	Out of term School Age Childcare

2. Early Childhood Care and Education Programme (ECCE), Access and Inclusion Model (AIM), National Childcare Scheme (NCS) and Community Childcare Subvention Plus (CCSP) Saver Programme.

In addition to Core Funding, this Partner Service is in contract to deliver the:

☐	National Childcare Scheme (NCS)
☒	Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE) programme
☐	Community Childcare Subvention Plus (CCSP) Saver Programme

Early Childhood Care and Education Programme (ECCE)

ECCE provides for 15 hours per week of preschool provision for 38 week services or 14 hours per week for 41 week services per year before children start primary school at no charge to parents/guardians. A child is eligible to start ECCE once they have turned 2 years and 8 months of age on, or prior to, 31 August that year.

As a Partner Service, we must offer ECCE to all eligible children within its service where we have committed to provide such a service above.

If you are availing of additional childcare, the balance of the childcare fees that you have to pay are the child's fees minus the ECCE hours which your child is eligible for. The hours you are awarded is paid by the Department to Ash's Angels Preschool for your child. Any additional childcare hours you are using outside of ECCE are eligible for an NCS subsidy (see details below).

Ash's Angels Preschool must provide you with written details of how the balance of your childcare fees are calculated (that is, the fee we charge less your free hours per week of preschool provision).

Asha Joanna O'Boyle will support you in registering your child for the ECCE programme in our service if your child meets the eligibility criteria. Further information about ECCE is available here -

<https://www.gov.ie/en/publication/2459ee-early-childhood-care-and-education-programme-ecce/>

Please note: In the ECCE Programme you are not required or obliged to select or pay a deposit for any optional extras.

If you do avail of any optional extra, should you, at any time, wish to withdraw from any of the optional extras selected, you should provide Ash's Angels Preschool with 4 weeks' notice.

Access and Inclusion Model (AIM)

The goal of AIM is to create a more inclusive environment in preschools, so all children, regardless of ability, can benefit from quality early learning and care. The model achieves this by providing universal supports to preschool settings, and targeted supports, which focus on the needs of the individual child, without requiring a diagnosis of disability.

Further information about AIM is available here - <https://aim.gov.ie/>

Optional:

This service also has an Inclusion Coordinator, Asha O'Boyle who has a special qualification focused on supporting the inclusion of all children in the service.

Calendars

Ash's Angels Preschool will provide you with a separate letter indicating the days our service is closed over the programme year. We will provide you with a minimum of 20 working days written notice period of our intention to change this.

3. Fees Policies

As a Partner Service, we operate a Fees Policy that is transparent and understandable to our parents/guardians and is compliant with the requirements under the Core Funding Partner Service Funding Agreement.

The fees for all our service types are displayed clearly and accurately on the Fee Table contained within this Parent Statement. Please do not hesitate to contact Asha Joanna O'Boyle who will provide additional clarification as required.

If we choose to withdraw from the scheme during the programme year (September 2026 – August 2027) we are required to give you, and Pobal the scheme administrator, 3 months written notice of our intention to withdraw.

The Department offers us, as a Partner Service the option of availing of Case Management supports if we are experiencing concerns regarding our viability as an alternative to withdrawing from the scheme, and removing the benefits of the scheme to parents/guardians.

3.1 Fee Management – As a Partner Service, we operate our Fees Policy in accordance with the Core Funding Partner Service Funding Agreement, which in programme year 2026/2027 involves no increases of fees on those charged to parents/guardians on 30 of September 2021, called an effective 'fee freeze'. There may be some exceptions to this rule, which can be found in <https://earlyyearshive.ncs.gov.ie/downloads/download-corefunding/>. In order that you can understand what this fee freeze means for you, we have outlined our fees and associated fees policy below.

☒	a) Our service was in existence on or before 30 September 2021 As a Partner Service, we are committed to operating the effective 'fee freeze' for Programme Year 2026/2027. This means that we will not charge our parents/guardians more for the same service than what we were charging in September 2021.
☐	b) Our service was established after 30 September 2021 This means, as a Partner Service that we will not charge our parents/guardians more for the same service than what we were charging when we first became a Partner service. We are committed to operating the effective 'fee freeze' for Programme Year 2026/2027.

3.2 Donations - We will not request or accept any regular or routine donations, voluntary or otherwise from parents/guardians, in respect of the ELC/SAC services being provided.

3.3 Deposits - We will not charge any non-refundable deposits¹ to parents/guardians in the respect of their ELC/SAC service where the parent/guardian takes up the service for which the deposit was paid.

3.4 Discounts – We will keep all discounts that were available on 30 September 2021 in place, provided that they are available to all children in our service. Any discount relevant to you will be applied to your normal fee.

3.5 Optional Extras – The term 'Optional Extra' is only applicable to any extra services or activities we offer under ECCE which are not funded by the Programmes but which are voluntary with optional charges to you. These optional extras are very limited in nature and there is a copy of the Department approved optional extras list available in Appendix 1 of the [ECCE programme rules](#), which are also available on the Early Years Hive.

3.6 Additional Service - Is when something additional to a service type/fee option is offered to parents/guardians. Take up of the additional service must be entirely optional to parents/guardians. For example, a service provider may offer school collection services in addition to their SAC Service Types, all

¹ Non-refundable deposits include administration/registration fees or other such charges.

additional extras must be entirely optional to parents/guardians and charged for additionally. These must appear on the fee table as applicable.

3.7 Fee Review Process - As a Partner Service, we must uphold our contractual obligations regarding our fees charged to parents/guardians as laid out in the Core Funding Partner Service Funding Agreement.

Where a parent/guardian/individual identifies a potential breach of Core Funding fee rules by a Partner Service, they may seek to have this examined and a conclusion reached through the [Core Funding Fee Review process](#).

A parent/guardian/individual who has identified a change to a Partner Service's fee policy potentially breaching the Core Funding Partner Service Funding Agreement, may address the issue in the first instance directly with the Service if they chose to do so.

In certain cases, this step may allow for the quick resolution of the case between the Partner Service and the parent/guardian without engagement with the CCC. This pre-fee review stage is optional.

Where a parent/guardian does not wish to engage with the service regarding their concerns or questions around Fee Management, a parent/guardian can raise the case directly with their local CCC. A list of CCC contact details is available from [City and County Childcare Committees](#).

3.8 Fee Policy

A. The fee policy we are going to implement for year 2026/2027 is the same as the fee policy that we had in place on 30 September 2021.

3.9 Fee Table
Programme Year: 2026/2027

3.9.1 - Section A: Fee Options

Fee Type Name	Session Type	Session Start Time	Session Finish Time	Hrs:Mins per Day	Days per Week	Hrs:Mins per Week	Weeks per year	Fee	Full Fee Non-ECCE Eligible Children	Effective From	Effective To
ECCE Morning 8:30 - 11:30	AM	08:30	11:30	3.00	5	15.00	38	€0	€0	31/08/2026	27/06/2027
ECCE Afternoon 12:00 - 15:00	PM	12:00	15:00	3.00	5	15.00	38	€0	€0	31/08/2026	27/06/2027

3.9.2 - Section B: Fee Extras:

Deposit / Discount / Optional Extras* / Additional Services

Type	Extras	Amount	Frequency	Other	Description	Additional Detail / Conditions	Effective From	Effective To
Deposit		€100	Once Off		€100 deposit - deposit is refundable once		31/08/2026	

					the child is registered on ECCE.			
Discount		€			We do not offer discounts		31/08/2026	
No Optional Extras		€						

* These are entirely optional to parents/guardians.

3.9.3 - Section C – Other Additional Information

3.10 The changes to our Fees Policy as applicable on September 30 2021 (or when we first became a Partner Service, whichever is earlier) are as follows:

3.10 (a) The following new Service Types ARE available:

Fee Type Name	SAC/ ELC	Age Range	Min Age	Max Age	ECCE available for ECCE Eligible Children	Session Start time	Session finish time	Incorporated Services ?	Choose incorporated Service	Additional Information	No. hours per day	No days per week	No. hours per week	Fee (less ECCE 3 Free Hours (€))	Full Fee

3.10(b) The following Service Types are NO LONGER available:

Fee Type Name	SAC/ ELC	Age Range	Min Age	Max Age	ECCE available for ECCE Eligible Children	Session Start time	Session finish time	Incorporated Services ?	Choose incorporated Service	Addition al Informati on	No. hours per day	No days per week	No. hours per week	Fee (less ECCE 3 Free Hours (€))	Full Fee

4. Quality measures

As a Partner Service, we are committed to delivering quality for children and families. There are number of ways we can show this.

4.1 Our staff have the following qualifications:

Room/Session	Qualification
Morning	Level 8 Early Childhood Studies
Afternoon	Level 8 Early Childhood Studies

4.2

☒	We are actively working to implement our Quality and Inclusion Practice Plan (QIPP) and we will report on progress at the end of the year to the Department of Children, Disability and Equality and our parents/guardians.
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Ash's Angels Preschool will display the end of year QIPP report in an area accessible to parents/guardians as well as on any online platform maintained by the Ash's Angels Preschool for the purpose of advertising its service or providing information to parents/guardians.

Queries -If you have any queries or wish to discuss any of the above, please contact **Asha Joanna O'Boyle**. Alternatively, you could address queries to your local **City/County Childcare Committee (CCC)**. A list of CCC contact details is available from [City and County Childcare Committees](#).

Ash's Angels Preschool will display this Parent Statement at all times in an area accessible to parents/guardians as well as on any online platform maintained by the Ash's Angels Preschool for the purpose of advertising its service or providing information to parents/guardians. Ash's Angels Preschool will print and co-sign a Parent Statement for each family. A copy signed by Ash's Angels Preschool and the parent/guardian will be retained on file. Any changes to Fee Policies will require that an updated Parent Statement is displayed and Ash's Angels Preschool will issue updated Parent Statements by email to our parents/guardians and retain proof of the associated email.

In this section include details of the child(ren), in this family only, enrolled at the service (as per parent/guardian name below):

Use BLOCK CAPITALS:

Child first name	Child family name

This Parent Statement is an agreement between the parent/guardian and the Partner Service. As a Partner Service, we will adhere to the scheme's terms and conditions outlined in the Core Funding Partner Service Funding Agreement, including those related to fee management. Further information on Core Funding is available here: <https://www.gov.ie/en/department-of-children-disability-and-equality/campaigns/core-funding/>.

This Parent Statement sets out what is on offer at Ash's Angels Preschool. We are responsible for ensuring that the fees represented in this Parent Statement are accurate, and represents all fees charged and the corresponding services offered.

If our Partner Service displays fees in another format in addition to this document that is permitted, however the fees charged must match the fees contained in this Parent Statement.

Programme Year:	2026/2027
Service Provider Name:	Ash's Angels Preschool
Service Reference No.:	18CC0622
Signed – Parent/Guardian:	
Parent/Guardian name in BLOCK CAPITALS:	
Date:	